



SHOGI

VARIANT LIBRARY

Japan's classic strategy game where captured pieces change sides

4

VARIANTS

2

PLAYERS

8+

AGE

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Shogi (将棋) is Japan's classic strategy board game, descended from the same chess lineage that spread across Asia before 1000 CE. The defining rule is the drop mechanic: captured pieces change allegiance and may be re-entered by the capturing player on any later turn, giving the game a dynamic character unlike any western chess variant. Ancient in origin and public domain in its mechanics, Shogi is governed competitively by the Japan Shogi Association, which holds no copyright over the game itself.

This library includes 4 playable variants.

STANDARD FORM

- ♦ [Standard Shogi](#) — The full 9×9 game with drops, promotion, and the complete piece set

SMALLER BOARD VARIANTS

- ♦ [Kyoto Shogi](#) — 5×5 game where every piece flips to its alternate face after each move
- ♦ [Minishogi](#) — Standard Shogi condensed to a 5×5 board with five pieces per side

DISTINCTIVE MECHANICS

- ♦ [Hasami Shogi](#) — 9×9 custodial-capture game with no drops, no promotion, and one piece type



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